



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PANAFRICAINNE DES ETUDIANTS
UNIÃO DOS ESTUDANTES DE TODA A ÁFRICA
اتحاد طلاب عموم إفريقيا



DEMOCRACY AND GOOD GOVERNANCE
WORKING GROUP



AASU ELECTION
OBSERVER MISSIONS

ELECTION OBSERVER MISSION



Being one of the top organisations that is championing the course of students all over Africa, AASU has for the past 47 years not relented in providing students with better opportunities in building their capacity, putting them in the spotlight as well as addressing their grievances on the continent. Through the discharge of its duties, AASU has undertaken several projects that are worth mentioning.

The commemoration of International Day of Education as well as the commemoration of International Day of Multilateralism and Diplomacy for Peace. Despite all these achievements, the union's quest to be more impactful and known on the continent is unmatched. Currently, as part of the union's 2020 objectives, an 'Election Observer Mission' will be instituted. Election Observation involves gathering information and making informed judgments that will in the long run have positive or negative impacts on the democracy of a country. In other words, it is the observation of election by one or more independent parties, typically from another country or a non-governmental organisation, primarily to assess the conduct of an election process based on national legislation and international election standards.

E.g., the AU and EISA EOM election observer mission. AASU in its resolve to be the voice of the youth will initiate this mission that seeks to promote the idea of election observation in Africa. The African Union Constitutive Act, the African Charter, the Agenda 2063, and the African Union Commission strategic plan 2004-2007 all focus on good governance, youth development and empowerment in various aspects of life. All these reiterate the fact that elections must be democratical tools that promote good governance and economic stability.

During the observation, the AASU OBSERVER TEAM will observe how all procedures provided by law in some selected countries are respected during elections. This is to allow students and young people to learn more about electioneering processes as well as present them with some experiences that will inform future decisions.

The aim of this is to implement an inclusive policy where students will have the opportunity to contribute and inform the world on happenings on election grounds as well as the aftermath of these elections. Moreover, it seeks to provide the African youth with an analytical and critical framework for the evaluation of political processes in upcoming elections that will be held in Africa.

THEORETICAL AND POLICY FOUNDATIONS OF THE ELECTION OBSERVER MISSION

The election observer mission is implemented by the All-Africa Students Union. The Election observer mission by AASU is to promote the idea of election observation on the African continent and to have an international experience on how elections are conducted in Africa. This is a non-political initiative that will promote the idea of independent observation and provide young students in Africa with analytical and critical framework for evaluation of political processes in upcoming elections that will be held in Africa. During this period, observers will monitor how all procedures provided by the laws of various countries are respected during elections. The aim of this is to allow students to learn much about electioneering processes as well as present them with some experiences that will inform future decisions.

OBJECTIVES OF THE ELECTION OBSERVER MISSION

As part of AASU's objectives of supporting democratisation and good governance in Africa, the union is committed to:

-  Election monitoring/ pre-post-election, local election, and other democracy related processes
-  Education and training on election and democracy related issues
-  Creation of an environment conducive to democratic development.
-  To support the enhancement of the integrity of electoral processes and minimise elections irregularities and human rights violation
-  To provide accurate, impartial information on issues related to general elections and prospects for democratic development in general
-  To support and strengthen local networks of other elections observation bodies in organising, informing, gathering and data exchanging activities during missions
-  To publish a mission report which underlines the outcome of the observation mission, of the observation team, together with recommendations for other electoral processes.

STRUCTURE OF THE ELECTION OBSERVER MISSION

As earlier stated, young students will be very monumental in this initiative. All the activities of the team will be coordinated with respect to a particular hierarchy of responsibility and flow of command. Since there will be various election centres, observers will be directed as to the number of polling stations they will visit. When this team is created, a leader will be assigned to every group (3 groups at most) that will at the end of the day report to the main leader of the Observer Mission Team.

SELECTED COUNTRY





TARGETED ELECTION OBSERVER MISSION COUNTRIES

Consideration was given to 2021 African elections, however, the outbreak and severity of COVID-19 militated against the initiative. We are therefore considering elections that will be held in 2022 with Kenya on our radar. The table below provides the necessary

Countries

Kenya

Type of Elections

**President, National Assembly,
Senate, County Assemblies
and local**

Date

11th April, 2021

THE SELECTION OF KENYA HAS BEEN BASED ON THE FOLLOWING:

- REGIONAL REPRESENTATION
- SECURITY SITUATION OF COUNTRY
- AVAILABILITY OF VOLUNTEERS
- DEMOCRATIC DISPENSATION OF THE COUNTRY

EXPECTED RESULTS FROM THE ELECTION OBSERVER MISSION

AASU intends to brief its partners, sponsors, and the general public with the necessary information or knowledge obtained from the beginning to the end of these elections. Daily reports of activities will be prepared from the first day the team embarks on the mission till the time the team departs. As it stands, the team is looking up to experiencing how elections are conducted, so in the end, our reports will focus on:

- 1 Giving accounts of what transpired before and after the election
- 2 Publishing report of activities
- 3 Suggesting reform measures in the occurrence of unexpected events

PROPOSED PARTNERS

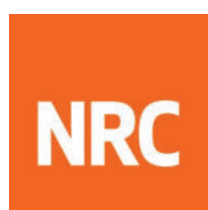
For the election observer mission to be carried out successfully, assistance from interested partners who are willing to support this project will be needed on board. Sponsors play a pivotal role in any programme that requires sponsorship. Therefore, we are looking at organisations with the pedigree and willingness to welcome our idea of students' inclusion in election observation since the outcome of these elections will inform their future policy decisions.



CODEO GHANA
Coalition of Domestic Election Observers



**Ghana Center for
Democratic Development**



Norwegian Resource
Bank for Democracy &
Human Rights



LOGISTICAL REQUIREMENTS OF THE ELECTION OBSERVER MISSION

Its resolve to strengthen democracy and good governance through election observer missions to maintain Africa's beaconing position on the political agenda and facilitate good coordination. The All-Africa Students Union would embark on its election observer mission in Kenya to observe their 2022 elections. The EOM team would spend approximately one week in the country. Through the assistance that we are confidently expecting from our sponsors, we look forward to working with a team of five people drawn from our offices. As part of our preparations, AASU will require assistance in the following sectors:

- Assistance with cost of transportation (to and fro)
- Accommodation
- Necessary apparel for identification
- Internal transport and security



ABOUT US



AASU is the largest student movement in Africa and a very dominant force on the Continent and beyond. The All-Africa Students Union (AASU) organises all students in Africa from the basic level to institutions of higher learning; in essence, the Union is the umbrella organisation for all students of Africa. AASU played important role in the struggle against colonialism and the ending of apartheid.

In the year 2000, the UN awarded AASU a certificate of merit in recognition of the Union's efforts at advancing students' rights and championing the democratisation of education across the African Continent.

See: <http://www.un.org/press/en/2000/20000410.dev2241.doc.html>

AASU is wholly student-run and student-led, autonomous, representative, democratically elected and operates according to democratic principles. The executive structure of the Union is representative of all the sub-regions across the Continent.

AASU's key strength lies in its diversity and numerical strength, which it employs as a bargaining tool to always speak for the supreme interests of students. The Union is made up of diverse students, regardless of their religion, gender, cultural background, political persuasion, ethnic origin, or social standing.





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